

you are now completely receptive to the idea of being yourself and living your own life. By now you have seen how much this inward quality has to do with setting free your mightiest powers.

Likewise you have seen that in this book I have paid some attention, but not very much, to the "nuts and bolts" of earning a very good living. The reason is not that "nuts and bolts" are not important; they are very important. This book, however, is devoted to helping you find and use *the basic drives that make a man*. When you have read this book—when you have read *and mastered* this book—the "nuts and bolts" come readily to your hand and you possess the skills which transfer those nuts and bolts into a mighty edifice of good fortune. When the basic drives are not under your conscious control, the components of a rich, rewarding life lie scattered and you may spend most of your life searching for some missing part.

We return, now, to the art of living your own life and being your own self, and shall look further into the ways in which this master skill strengthens and sustains you.

One of these days you will be in a clothing store. If some salesman tells you: "This is what everyone is wearing this season," don't be persuaded. Be yourself. Select colors, fabrics and styles which suit *you*. Tell the salesman that you prefer something that everyone is *not* wearing. Either walk out of that store without having made a purchase, or buy with regard to your own tastes only.

One of these days you will be in a restaurant. Waiters often receive word from the proprietor or from the cook to "push" some item, perhaps because it brings a high profit, perhaps because there is too much of it at hand. If your waiter urges some item upon you, smile, shake your head, and order exactly what you would like to have from the menu.

You may greatly admire some person for a particular skill or talent he shows. Wishing to exercise a similar skill, you may decide you are going to "be" that person. You will have wasted a great deal of time and effort before you discover that personality is a very subtle thing and that nobody can "be" anyone else without harming his own personality and crippling the drives that can make him great in his own right.

In my youth I decided to write the way Arthur Brisbane wrote. He was a very versatile and capable writer with a huge following, and I thought I was being smart when I set out to